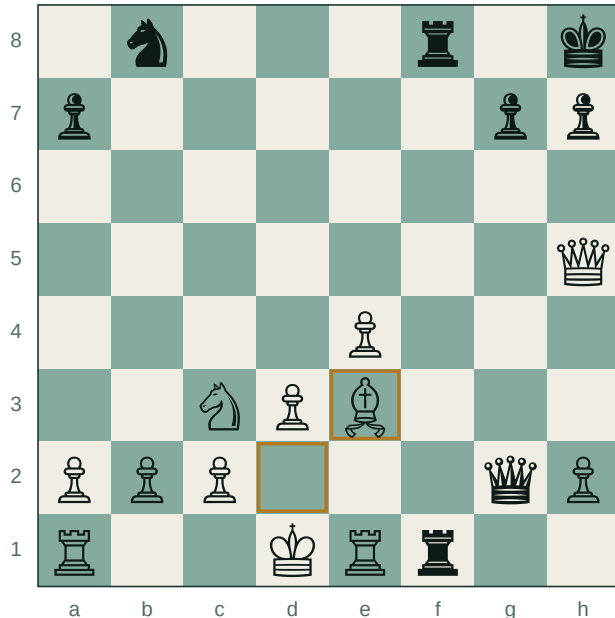


Attraction tactics: Black, move 21

Attraction tactics

Black to move



Previous move: 21.Be3. Gold borders mark its start and finish.

WORKED CONTINUATION - COVER THIS SECTION FIRST

21...Rxe1+ 22. Kxe1 Rf1#

21...Rxe1+ Check restricts White to 1 legal reply here. From e1 it attacks king on d1 and bishop on e3. Recorded reply: **22.Kxe1**.

22...Rf1# Mate: rook on f1 gives check; White has no legal reply.

The line ends in checkmate against the king on e1. Material gain is unnecessary once no legal defense exists.

CHECKPOINT

Which piece delivers the final check, and why can the defender not continue? **Answer:** Rook on f1. The king is in check and the position has zero legal replies.

CARRY THE IDEA INTO YOUR GAMES

The opponent may decline the offered material. Compare refusal with the recorded continuation before calling the sacrifice forced.

WHAT THIS POSITION TEACHES

Attraction draws a piece onto a square where a later tactic becomes possible. Sacrifices often work by changing the king's or queen's location rather than winning immediately.

HOW TO LOOK

Ask which enemy piece must be moved to a specific square for your next check, fork, or mating pattern to work.

The defending king is on d1. Absolute pin: rook on e1.